

One-on-One Oral Decoding Diagnostic Guide & Rubric

Aligned Standards: MN ELA 7.1.4.4 / 8.1.4.4 (Decoding/Word Analysis) & MN ELA 7.3.1.1 / 8.3.1.1 (Diagnostic Discussion)

1. Diagnostic Protocol & Observation Instructions

This tool is designed for peer-to-peer and teacher-to-student 1-on-1 diagnostic sessions. The evaluator observes as the speaker reads CVC word chains aloud and articulates medial vowel changes. Evaluators record specific phonetic accuracy, response fluency, and quality of oral explanation.

2. Oral Decoding Accuracy Rubric (MN ELA 7.1.4.4 / 8.1.4.4)

Performance Benchmark	Phoneme Isolation & Accuracy	Word Chain Fluency
Level 1 Needs Support	Struggles to isolate medial vowel phonemes; frequently mispronounces short vowels.	Requires frequent teacher intervention; hesitates significantly between substitutions.
Level 2 Developing	Identifies medial vowel changes with prompting; occasional sound confusion.	Decodes individual words with deliberate pause; requires assistance on long chains.
Level 3 Proficient	Independently swaps medial vowels correctly (e.g., CAT -> COT -> CUT).	Reads word chains smoothly with minimal pause; self-corrects phoneme errors.
Level 4 Advanced	Fluently decodes complex real/nonsense CVC chains with complete accuracy.	Demonstrates immediate automaticity; accurately articulates tongue/mouth mechanics.

3. 1-on-1 Diagnostic Discussion Rubric (MN ELA 7.3.1.1 / 8.3.1.1)

Criteria	Target Verbal Demonstration	Evaluator Quality Check
Phonological Explanation	Student clearly explains how altering the medial vowel changes word sound and meaning (e.g., PIN to PAN).	Uses terms like 'medial vowel', 'phoneme', 'short vowel sound', and 'vocal shift'.
Collaborative Exchange	Actively responds to diagnostic questions from peer/teacher with clear articulation.	Maintains focused dialog; asks clarifying questions when a decoding error occurs.

4. Diagnostic Scoring & Observation Form

Student Name:

Evaluator Name:

Date: _____

Assessed Word Chain: _____

Assessed Level: ☐ Level 1 ☐ Level 2 ☐ Level 3 ☐ Level 4

Diagnostic Feedback / Notes: